

Chapter 165-3

By the end, Zhao Xuning was tired. She sat on the sofa hugging a throw pillow and said softly, "I ran all over half of Haizhou to buy this. I went to seven shopping malls."

Liang Shi placed the cup of hot water on the coffee table and stood before her. "Drink this first."

Zhao Xuning continued talking to herself, "You all say I'm going to suffer because of my personality, but I really tried my best. I... what am I supposed to do? I don't know."

Zhao Xuning pounded her fist on the pillow. "It was my first time being in a relationship too. I liked her, and I listened to everything she said. What exactly did I do wrong in that incident? I was going crazy. It hurt when I woke up in the middle of the night too. That was Shen Hui—I nearly watched her die."

Zhao Xuning's words had lost all logic by now; she was just saying whatever came to mind.

It was all complaints and grievances, anyway.

But this was also how Liang Shi finally learned the reason for their breakup. Apparently, that day Zhao Xuning had been invited to a gathering by a classmate of theirs—someone who was on slightly better terms with Shen Hui and had helped her with a research project before. So Zhao Xuning felt too embarrassed to refuse and went. Meanwhile, Shen Hui happened to have a deadline approaching and was at home busy writing her thesis.

What was supposed to be a group gathering turned out to be only four people, and one pair of them was a couple.

Zhao Xuning didn't drink any alcohol the entire time.

At the time, she felt something was off, especially since that couple kept making jokes about her and the person who had invited her.

Their jokes were quite inappropriate. Zhao Xuning quietly distanced herself from that person without making it obvious.

She avoided the alcohol, but she never expected that person had drugged the water.

It was a drug with hallucinogenic properties.

At first, Zhao Xuning thought the water itself was the problem. It was only later upon examination that she discovered it was the cup—the drug had been applied to her water cup.

After the couple left, that person asked Zhao Xuning to stay under the pretense of discussing a research project. Zhao Xuning actually wanted to leave, but she was half-pulled, half-pushed into staying in the room.

As soon as the couple left, she noticed something was wrong with her body.

But the drug was indeed potent—she didn't even have as much strength as the other person anymore.

For a few minutes afterward, she mistook that person for Shen Hui.

It was only at the critical moment that she was able to distinguish by scent. Just as she was about to push that person off the bed, Shen Hui pushed open the door and walked in.

After that, Shen Hui was so shaken by the scene that she ran out and collided with a motorcycle.

She was only grazed slightly and fell over, but who could have known she was pregnant.

Zhao Xuning told Liang Shi the whole story several times, asking repeatedly, "What exactly did I do wrong?"

"If I had known that would happen that night, I definitely wouldn't have gone."

After listening, Liang Shi simply handed the cup to Zhao Xuning. "Drink some hot water, or you'll catch a cold tomorrow."

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Liang Shi's words proved prophetic.

Zhao Xuning really did catch a cold—she spent five of the seven days of her New Year holiday sick.

However, after sobering up, Zhao Xuning moved. She moved back to the rooftop apartment.

The place where she used to live with Shen Hui.

On the day she finished moving and had everything settled, Liang Shi went over to her place to have a meal, bringing Xu Qingzhu along for hotpot.

Of course, Ling Dang and Sheng Yu were there too.

The two little girls played cops and robbers upstairs, running back and forth through the living room.

Zhao Xuning watched them and fell silent, but she returned to normal after a short while.

After living in the same residential complex as Zhao Xuning, the group became much closer.

However, Liang Shi and her wife were a couple, while Zhao Xuning was alone and busy with work. Liang Shi often saw Zhao Xuning leaving for night shifts.

When she went downstairs for her morning jog, she would happen to run into Zhao Xuning coming back from the hospital, and they would all go out for breakfast together.

Liang Shi didn't dare ask about her and Shen Hui again, nor did she mention Zhao Xuning and Shen Hui's situation to Xu Qingzhu.

It was just that one day, feeling particularly emotional, she asked Xu Qingzhu, "Do you think Shen Hui still loves Zhao Xuning?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded without hesitation. "Yes."

Liang Shi sighed softly. "Then why can't people who love each other be together?"

Xu Qingzhu suddenly paused and asked in return, "Did you know those two fell in love at first sight?"

"Mm... I suppose I knew that."

"The two of them seemed to have had no adjustment period at all—they went straight into the honeymoon phase." Xu Qingzhu said, "I only heard Dr. Zhao mention it once. Their relationship didn't follow the normal process."

Liang Shi said, "Doesn't that prove they're a match made in heaven?"

Xu Qingzhu slowly shook her head. "How can two people not need an adjustment period? They just never encountered any major issues. When they finally did encounter something major—it was somewhat extreme, yes—but they really did fall apart."

"When you're immersed in love, you can ignore everything. You might not even really know what the other person's true personality is like. It looks like you understand each other, but actually, you don't." Xu Qingzhu spoke while thinking it through. "They skipped the process of getting to know each other during the ambiguous phase. They got together too intensely. Then, after many years, they really did love each other—but they were also genuinely at odds with each other."

Both of their personalities were somewhat extreme.

Zhao Xuning was extremely reserved.

To say she didn't love Shen Hui? That was definitely not possible.

But she truly wasn't good at expressing herself and didn't know how to back down or yield.

Who knows how they got through all those years together, but when it came to major issues, she was just... silent.

If she could have apologized back then, yielded a little, coaxed Shen Hui with a few words—given how much Shen Hui loved her, they probably wouldn't have broken up.

But she didn't.

Shen Hui was extremely proud.

Her pride was in her bones. For small matters, she could let things go, but for major issues, you had to yield—otherwise, she would fight you to the bitter end.

What she wanted was precisely what Zhao Xuning couldn't give.

At the root of it all, whether in life or in love, both of them had previously had things go too smoothly.

After listening to Xu Qingzhu's analysis, Liang Shi suddenly felt enlightened.

"What about us?" Liang Shi suddenly asked. "We also seem to be... We won't go down the same path as them, will we?"

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her. "Have we experienced few major issues between us?"

Liang Shi: "..."

That was true.